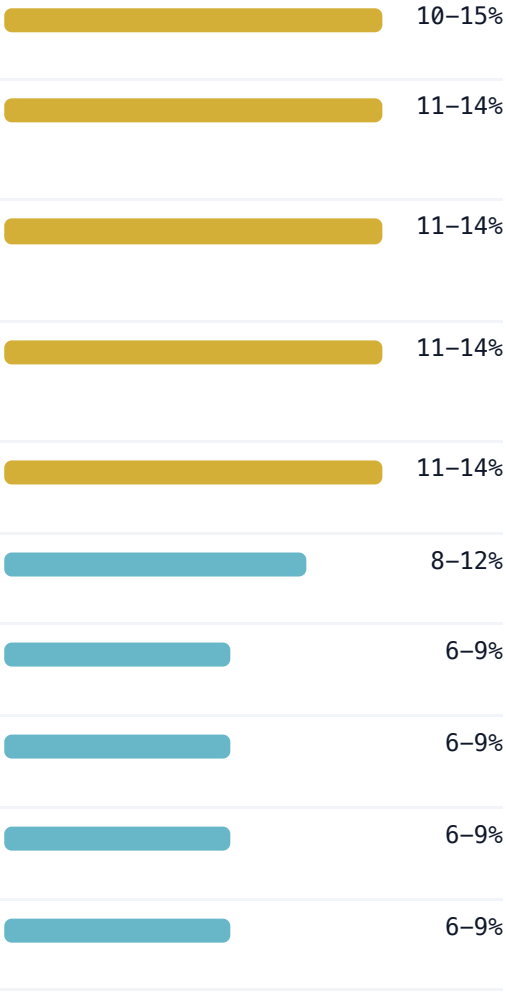
FINANCE IN PRACTICE · FREE GUIDE

CFA® Level I *Exam Map*

Where the marks are, how the exam works, and a 12-week route to exam day.

180	2 × 135	300+	43%
multiple-choice questions	minutes, two sessions	study hours reported by passing candidates	pass rate, Aug 2026 (CFA Institute)

Where the marks are, and what to master



High priority: the heaviest topics. Weights: CFA Institute 2027 topic outline.

> **The five gold topics are about 55–70% of the exam.** Ethics, Quant, FSA, Equities and Fixed Income decide most results. Master them first, then build the rest around them.

Exam windows: Level I runs in February, May, August and November. Check dates and fees at cfainstitute.org.

STRATEGY

A 12-week route that follows how topics build on each other

About 25 hours a week. Studying 15 hours a week? Stretch the same order over 20 weeks.

Wk 1–2	**Quantitative Methods + Economics**	The toolkit: time value, statistics, rates.
Wk 3–4	**Financial Statement Analysis**	Biggest reading load. Start early.
Wk 5	**Corporate Finance**	Short; builds on FSA.
Wk 6–7	**Equities**	Valuation models and market structure.
Wk 8–9	**Fixed Income**	Pricing, yield, duration. Practise daily.
Wk 10	**Derivatives + Alternative Investments**	Payoffs and how each asset behaves.
Wk 11	**Portfolio Construction + Ethics**	Ethics last, so it is fresh on exam day.
Wk 12	**Mock exams + review**	Two full mocks. Fix the error pattern, not just the question.

How to study it

- **Practise the week you learn.** Do questions on each reading within days, not saved for the end.
- **Keep an error log.** Write why each wrong answer was wrong; retake those questions until you get them right twice.
- **Gold topics first, none skipped.** The 6–9% topics still decide close results.
- **Last month is questions and mocks.** Reading new material late costs more than it adds.

Exam-day rules worth knowing

- **About 90 seconds per question.** Flag anything over two minutes and come back.
- **No penalty for wrong answers.** Never leave a question blank.
- **Formulas are not given.** Know them well enough to rebuild them, not just recite them.
- **Mocks under exam timing** in the last two weeks show your real pace.

PRACTISE WITH US

Your prep keeps going between sessions

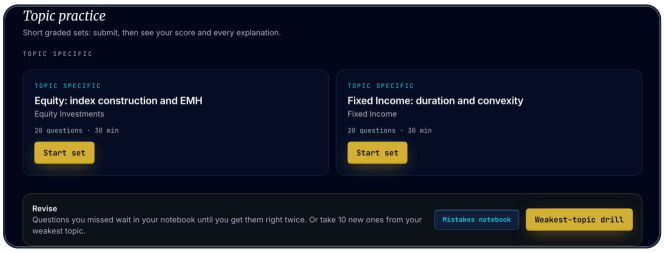
Our students sit full timed mocks and topic exams on a screen like exam day's, compare every result with the last one, and drill their weakest topic. financeinpractice.me/#portal



Exam-day screen. Clock, question map, flags, crossing out and notes.



Results compared. Every mock and every topic against your last attempt.



Topic exams and a weakest-topic drill. Missed questions wait in a notebook until you get them right twice.

Free daily question

A new exam-style question on our website every day, each with the worked solution, why the wrong answers are wrong and the exam trap. Every Level I question is here:

financeinpractice.me/cfa/questions?level=1

Sample student data.

Want this plan built around your exam date?

Book a free 30-minute diagnostic session. We find your weak topics and map your route to exam day. At your home in Abu Dhabi or live online.

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